HL7 AU Project Scope Statement

AU Provider Directory FHIR Implementation Guide

This form is to be completed for new releases for previously published standards or other products, or for reaffirmation, re-circulation or withdrawal ballots (Project Scope Statement only).

A project proposal is not necessary for new releases of previously published standards, or for reaffirmation, re-circulation or withdrawal ballots.

The correct completion of the submitted form will ensure that the Board is presented with all the required information to support their consideration and approval process in a timely manner. The content will provide transparency to stakeholders on the project, expectations, direction and timeframes which in turn will support consensus-based standards development.

Please submit completed forms to projects@hl7.com.au

Project Scope Statement

Project Title	AU Provider Directory FHIR Implementation Guide
Project Description	This project will update the Australian Provider Directory (AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY) FHIR Implementation Guide so that it formally derives from AU Core, making AU Core the shared starting point for national provider and service directory specifications in Australia. This will align AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY with current Australian interoperability expectations, ensuring it is at least as constrained as AU Core while keeping the directory-specific requirements that AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY needs.
Project Need	AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY currently derives from AU Base R4, creating divergence from contemporary national interoperability standards. Deriving AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY from AU Core ensures consistency, reduces fragmentation, and modernises national directory infrastructure. This would consolidate AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY to create alignment between national Provider Directories that would be more likely to derive from it should it be derived itself from AU Core.
Project Scope	Update all AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY profiles (where possible) to derive from AU Core, including base definition changes, structure alignment, removing redundancy where inheritance would occur from AU Core, identifier and name slicing alignment, correction of terminology URLs, and incorporation of inherited AU Core Must Support obligations with AU Core Actors. No changes will be made to AU Core itself. By deriving AU Provider Directory from AU Core, the IG will gain a more modern and consistent foundation for representing: • Organisations, • Practitioners, • PractitionerRoles, • Locations, • HealthcareServices, and • potentially Endpoints (pending other work). By deriving AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY from AU Core this ensures that downstream directories can stay better aligned over time, making it easier for existing and future provider directories such as the National Health Services Directory (NHSD), Health Connect Provider Directory (HCPD), and other jurisdictional or program specific directories to derive from AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY with confidence.

<table>
<tr><td></td><td colspan="6">Having this clear lineage helps reduce unnecessary variation between directory implementations, improves cross-system interoperability, and simplifies implementation for vendors. It also strengthens AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY’s role as a practical middle layer between AU Core and downstream directory specifications, without introducing any changes to AU Core itself.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Product Info</td><td>Product Family</td><td>Product</td><td>Intent</td><td>Lineage</td><td>Release Type</td><td>Target Release</td></tr>
<tr><td>FHIR</td><td>Implementation Guide</td><td>Update Existing</td><td>AU PD</td><td>Working Standard</td><td>Q2 2027 Publication March 2027 Ballot</td></tr>
<tr><td>Primary Governing Group</td><td colspan="6">HL7 AU FHIR Working Group</td></tr>
<tr><td>Primary Responsible Group</td><td colspan="6">HL7 AU FHIR Working Group</td></tr>
<tr><td>Other Associated Work Group(s) or Subcommittee(s)</td><td colspan="6">None</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="5">Project Team</td><td colspan="3">Project Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Ricardo Inacio</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">FHIR IG Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Uday Chandrupatla and Sam Turner</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Publishing Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Brett Esler (HL7 AU)</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Vocabulary Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Charlie Chen</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Modelling Facilitator</td><td colspan="3">Uday Chandrupatla, Stuart Hanson and Sam Turner</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="4">Supporting Organisations</td><td colspan="3">HL7 Australia</td><td colspan="3">Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Healthdirect</td><td colspan="3">Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Department of Health, Disability and Ageing</td><td colspan="3">Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">Australian Digital Health Agency</td><td colspan="3">Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td>Other Interested Parties</td><td colspan="6">CSIRO</td></tr>
<tr><td>Developing Organisation(s)</td><td colspan="6">Australian Digital Health Agency</td></tr>
<tr><td>FHIR Accelerator(s)</td><td colspan="6">N/A</td></tr>
<tr><td>External Drivers</td><td colspan="6">With the growing number of implementations of provider directory use-cases in Australia, it is important to have a nationally agreed baseline specification that can be adopted /</td></tr>
</table>

	derived from. Australia had already identified this need and developed the AU PROVIDER DIRECTORY FHIR Implementation Guide, and this project recognises the work done and seeks to implement measures that will bring the Implementation Guide back to a current state, to ensure it fulfils its original intent
Dependencies	AU Core v3.0.0
	AU Base v7.0.0 (including the endpoint profile under development)
	AU eRequesting v1.0.0
Related Projects	AU Core FHIR Implementation Guide AU Base FHIR Implementation Guide
HL7 AU Managed Project Repository URL	https://github.com/hl7au/au-fhir-pd
Compatibility	Backwards Compatibility: There are known backwards incompatibilities with the previously released AU PD 2 (https://hl7.org.au/fhir/pd/pd2/index.html) (**note** that AU PD 2 has not been balloted) AU Base Variance: No expected variance AU Core Variance: No expected variance
External Code Systems	Yes SNOMED CT, LOINC, NCTS (healthterminologies.gov.au), PBS, MIMS
Joint Copyright	Yes. Joint copyright HL7 and HL7 Australia, licensed under Creative Commons Public Domain as per HL7 AU IP Policy.
External Project Collaboration	-
Stakeholders	Clinical Peak Bodies, Software Vendors, Service Providers, Health Jurisdictions, Federal Agencies, Standards Development Organisations (SDOs).
>50% External Content	No
Developers of External Content	N/A
Realm	AU